

THE LIGHT OF BUBU

A TALE OF RENEWAL IN
THE FORGOTTEN LAND



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Prologue

Deep in the forest where shadows were cast by the dense, broad-leaved evergreen trees, where sunlight streamed through their canopies, and where the life the biome held enacted its quotidian custom, fell a light from a large oak tree. Levitating beneath this humongous tree, the light glowed with a luminous golden light that incandescently suffused the space it occupied. The glow fanned out, swallowing more space as it shone more dazzlingly to birth an appearance which seemed nebulous behind the illuminating light. As the figure began to take form, the light progressively ebbed until it waned to a soft radiance from which a divinely beguiling little girl with long, black, curly locks emerged. The light eventually died out, but the quintessence of the being it was displaced by appeared to radiate its prior profound golden intensity.



The little girl bore striking features with almond-shaped eyes, a delicately pert nose, full lips, and a golden-yellow complexion. Her dark African curls grew lushly, forming a mane around her heart-shaped face. She lifted her gaze eastward, in the direction of the village of Bubu. Bubu, situated a short distance from the forest and encircled by its fringes, was infamous for its ill luck. Mishaps never ceased to be in the offing every passing day. Though its inhabitants were accustomed to their misfortune, surrounding villages held them in derision.

The circumstances that buttressed the ill fate suffusing the region were the practically barren land, the malnourished livestock they bred, a slight drought, and a perduring, unfavourable climate. These conditions appeared to place them on the verge of famine. Accompanying these were the dwellers' reactions to their impoverished lives, as they bickered and groused over issues as trifling as missing chickens or goats, delinquent debts, and the like, ending in even more gratuitous misfortune.



The little girl grinned softly and ambled along the path towards the indigent settlement to be the revivifying hope and light that brightened their monotonous, dreary praxis and illuminated their way to betterment. To be the Light of Bubu.